

web developers, who work in the mobile space and develop mobile web pages or Rich Internet Applications.

Education, certification and employment

The people most suited for this field have a technical background. They could be B.E. or B.Tech, B.CA, M.CA or Computer Science graduates. Such courses impart a certain amount of base knowledge in terms of coding such as C++ or C# or technologies such as J2EE. But these curriculum driven skill-sets do not necessarily prepare students for employability. Perhaps this is why you have India-based training institutes such as www.FresherLab.com and www.edumobile.org cropping up. Sushant, CTO of Porting Lab that runs EDUMobile echoed our opinion reasoning when he said, “we felt that there is wide gap between the knowledge imparted by universities and that required for the market place and so we thought of creating modular training programs to augment the university training available to most engineers. Even mainstream institutes have now acknowledged the rise of this sector and have begun offering courses for the same. Even IIT-Delhi offers a masters course in Mobile Computing which doesn’t focus on app development but rather will provide conceptual knowledge of the mobile platform in general.

When Windows Phone 7 was newly launched, DreamSpark (www.dreamspark.com) ensured plenty of support systems for developers – be it access to devices to test their applications, access to the latest SDKs or even getting their applications on to the marketplace. The Microsoft program provided free tools such as Visual Studio to students. Even before WP7, DreamSpark had about 3 million students who were part of this program and it’s pretty easy to get a Dreamspark membership using an ISIC identity card.

Knowledge base

If students want to gain capability, they should have the requisite skill sets to develop across all platforms. A platform is like a channel of distribution. If you have expertise on only one type of platform you’re leaving out opportunities to monetise other channels. If you’re comfortable with, say, development in J2ME and want to port your app to the Symbian platform you need to look at developing a few ancillary skills. “Qt is a good place to start”, advises Anup C Shan, a web developer at Oracle who also builds mobile apps as a hobby. Qt is a cross-platform application framework for developing applications with a graphical user interface (GUI). It’s used for the KDE environment on Linux and is platform independent. With Qt,